WITS AHEAD RESEARCH GROUP

The AHEAD Fortnightly

Toleo 2 · 15 Oktoba 2026 · Wits School of Education, University of the Witwatersrand

Katika wiki hizi mbili, swali limehama kutoka kama vyuo vikuu vinapaswa kukumbatia akili bandia hadi jinsi vinavyofanya maamuzi. Waziri Buti Manamela aliuambia mkutano wa Universities South Africa kwamba ni wakati wa kuhama kutoka mjadala hadi maamuzi kuhusu ufundishaji na utafiti, na wanasayansi wawili wa kompyuta wa Wits, kutoka RAIL Lab, walisema Afrika inapaswa kuweka ajenda yake yenyewe ya utafiti wa akili bandia badala ya kutumia tu zana zilizotengenezwa kwingineko. Wakati huohuo, vyuo vikuu vya nje vinaachana na zana za kugundua akili bandia na masharti mapya ya leseni yaliyopendekezwa na Turnitin, jambo linalotukumbusha kwamba imani na busara haviwezi kukabidhiwa programu za kompyuta. Kwetu sisi katika Wits AHEAD, haya ndiyo maamuzi yanayojenga uwezo wa binadamu, na toleo hili linawafikia kwa lugha kumi na tatu.

MAMBO MATATU YA KUJUA

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NEWS · 14 OCTOBER 2026 · GLOBAL

Joining up AI across recruitment, retention and alumni relations can close graduation gaps, if it is governed well

Akiandika katika University World News, mkurugenzi wa mradi wa IREX, Cameron Mirza, anasema vyuo vikuu vinapaswa kuchukulia uandikishaji, uwabakizaji wa wanafunzi na uhusiano na wahitimu kama mzunguko mmoja uliounganishwa na kusaidiwa na akili bandia, badala ya mifumo tofauti yenye data tofauti. Anatolea mfano programu ya chatbot na uchanganuzi wa utabiri wa Georgia State University, inayosifiwa kwa kupunguza "summer melt" kwa takribani asilimia 21, na kusaidia wanafunzi weusi, Wahispania, wa kizazi cha kwanza na wenye kipato duni kuhitimu kwa viwango vinavyolingana au kuzidi vya jumla ya wanafunzi wote, huku akionya kuwa modeli zilizofunzwa kwa data za kihistoria zinaweza pia kuendeleza ukosefu wa usawa ambao zinapaswa kuurekebisha.

> **Kwa nini ni muhimu:** Kwa nguzo ya Wits AHEAD kuhusu akili bandia na uchanganuzi wa utabiri kwa mafanikio ya wanafunzi, makala hii ni ukumbusho muhimu kwamba zana za tahadhari za mapema na uwabakizaji hupunguza mapengo ya usawa tu pale zinapooanishwa na usimamizi wa kibinadamu na upimaji wa upendeleo, hilo ndilo swali la utawala ambalo Wits AHEAD huuliza kuhusu zana yoyote ya uchanganuzi inayopendekeza.

University World News · universityworldnews.com · Soma kwenye chanzo

Mirza, C. (2026, October 14). How AI improves student recruitment, retention, advancement. *University World News*. universityworldnews.com/post.php?story=20261014130619431

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NEWS · 13 OCTOBER 2026 · SOUTH AFRICA

Wits researchers argue Africa must set its own AI research agenda, not just apply others' tools

Wanasayansi wawili wa kompyuta wa University of the Witwatersrand, Benjamin Rosman na Steve James, ambao ni waelekezi wenza wa Robotics, Autonomous Intelligence and Learning (RAIL) Lab, wanasema Afrika inapaswa kuongoza utafiti wa akili bandia badala ya kutumia tu zana zilizotengenezwa kwingineko. Wanataja Deep Learning Indaba, ambayo sasa ni shule kubwa zaidi duniani ya majira ya kiangazi kuhusu akili bandia, iliyovutia washiriki 1,300 katika mkutano wa mwaka jana mjini Kigali na inaendesha programu yake ya IndabaX katika nchi 48 kati ya 54 za Afrika mwaka huu, pamoja na taasisi mpya ya Wits ya Machine Intelligence and Neural Discovery (MIND) Institute, inayounganisha wasomi wapatao 65 kutoka sayansi ya kompyuta, sayansi ya neva, saikolojia na sera.

> **Kwa nini ni muhimu:** Kwa nguzo ya Wits AHEAD kuhusu akili bandia inayowajibika, maadili, usawa na sera, onyo dhidi ya Afrika kuwa tu "mahali pa watu wengine kufanya sayansi" linahusiana moja kwa moja na dhamira ya Wits AHEAD ya kujenga uwezo unaoongozwa na Waafrika wa kuweka maswali ya utafiti wa akili bandia, si tu kutumia zana za akili bandia zilizobuniwa kwingineko.

Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · Soma kwenye chanzo

Luckhurst, G. (2026, October 13). Africa has crucial role in advancing study of AI, say professors. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/africa-has-crucial-role-advancing-study-ai-say-professors

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NEWS · 9 OCTOBER 2026 · UNITED KINGDOM

More universities end Turnitin contracts as concerns mount

Gazeti la Times Higher Education linaripoti kuwa vyuo vikuu vya Newcastle na Westminster vimejiunga na Chuo Kikuu cha Southampton katika kusitisha mikataba yao na kampuni ya kugundua wizi wa kazi za kiakademia, Turnitin, baada ya kampuni hiyo kupendekeza mabadiliko ya leseni ambayo yangeweza kuruhusu kazi za wanafunzi kutumika kufundisha zana za akili bandia. Newcastle ilitaja wazi kipengele hicho cha data; Westminster ilisema kifaa cha Turnitin cha kugundua wizi 'hakikuwa na ufanisi mkubwa' kukabiliana na maandishi yaliyoandikwa na akili bandia, na kifaa chake cha kugundua akili bandia kilikuwa na 'hatari inayotambulika ya kutoa matokeo ya uongo chanya'. Southampton peke yake ililipa Turnitin paundi 87,621 kwa mwaka mmoja, kati ya wanafunzi zaidi ya 17,000 wa shahada ya kwanza na 8,000 wa shahada za uzamili.

> **Kwa nini ni muhimu:** Kwa nguzo ya Wits AHEAD kuhusu akili bandia inayowajibika, maadili, usawa na sera, mgogoro huu unaonyesha vyuo vikuu vikianza kupima utawala wa data na uhalisia wa uwezo wa zana za kugundua akili bandia dhidi ya gharama, badala ya kuchukulia mkataba wa kugundua wizi wa kazi za kiakademia kama lazima isiyobadilika.

Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · Soma kwenye chanzo

Luckhurst, G. (2026, October 9). More universities end Turnitin contracts as concerns mount. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/more-universities-end-turnitin-contracts-concerns-mount

UTAFITI NA RIPOTI

Prepare students for post-graduation AI judgement challenges

University World News · 9 October 2026 · Pillar 4: Graduate capability and just transitions. Kwa nguzo ya Wits AHEAD kuhusu akili bandia, uwezo wa wahitimu, uwezo wa kuajirika na mabadiliko ya haki, ugunduzi huu kwamba kazi ya akili bandia iliyokosea lakini ikijionyesha kwa kujiamini inaweza kusomeka kwa ushawishi sawa na kazi sahihi unaonyesha kuwa uamuzi wa kitaaluma, si ujuzi wa akili bandia peke yake, ndiyo uwezo unaowahitajika zaidi na wahitimu kabla ya kuingia soko la ajira.

Nguyen, P. (2026, October 9). Prepare students for post-graduation AI judgement challenges. *University World News*. universityworldnews.com/post.php?story=20261009115040153

South African minister tells universities to move from AI debate to decisions on teaching and research

South African Government News Agency (SAnews) · 8 October 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. Kwa nguzo ya Wits AHEAD kuhusu akili bandia zalishi katika elimu ya juu, waziri wa baraza la mawaziri kuweka ajenda thabiti kuhusu ufundishaji, tathmini na uwezo wa utafiti badala ya mjadala wa jumla, inawapa vyuo vikuu vya Afrika Kusini dhamira dhahiri ya kutekeleza.

South African Government News Agency. (2026, October 8). *Universities challenged to prepare graduates for AI-driven future*. SAnews. sanews.gov.za/node/84823

Grappling with "homework scams", US universities shun AI detectors

AFP (via eNCA) · 6 October 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. Akili bandia zalishi katika elimu ya juu, hususan tathmini na uadilifu wa kitaaluma, ni Nguzo ya 1 ya Wits AHEAD, na kurudi nyuma huku kwa programu za kugundua akili bandia katika vyuo vikuu vinavyoongoza ni ishara ya moja kwa moja na ya vitendo ya jinsi kikundi kinavyopaswa kushauri kuhusu kubadilisha tathmini badala ya ugunduzi kama jibu la matumizi mabaya ya akili bandia.

Chopra, A. (2026, October 6). Grappling with "homework scams", US universities shun AI detectors. *eNCA*. enca.com/lifestyle/grappling-homework-scams-us-universities-shun-ai-detectors

Six publishers agree to feed 20 million research papers to AI agents, in a pay-per-use deal

Times Higher Education · 6 October 2026 · Pillar 6: Responsible AI and policy. Kwa nguzo ya Wits AHEAD kuhusu akili bandia inayowajibika, maadili, usawa na sera, mkataba huu ni jaribio la awali la jinsi uchapishaji wa kitaaluma unavyoweza kuifanya akili bandia kutegemea utafiti ulioidhinishwa badala ya kubahatisha, huku ikitafutwa jinsi ya kulipa pale mashine, si msomaji, inapofanya urejeleaji.

Jones, F. (2026, October 6). Publishers to share 20 million research papers with AI start-up. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/publishers-share-20-million-research-papers-ai-start

TAZAMA

▶ UNESCO and Codemao's AI coding drive reaches more African classrooms (1 min)

Xinhua (New China TV). UNESCO na jukwaa la China la kuandika programu, Codemao, wanasema mradi wao wa pamoja wa kufundisha vijana kuandika kanuni za kompyuta unaendelea kukua barani Afrika. Awamu ya pili, itakayoendelea hadi 2030, tayari imewafundisha walimu 200 katika Jamhuri ya Kongo, Kenya, Namibia na Thailand, asilimia 45 kati yao wakiwa wanawake, na Kenya imepewa vishkwambi 200 kwa shule 20 za sekondari za chini.

▶ A college president on harnessing AI in education without cutting corners (5 min)

ABC News. Rais wa Colby College, David Greene, anaieleza ABC News jinsi chuo hicho cha Marekani cha masomo ya sanaa huria kinavyotumia akili bandia katika ufundishaji na ujifunzaji kwa njia anayoieleza kuwa ya kimaadili na isiyotumia njia za mkato. Ni simulizi fupi ya moja kwa moja kuhusu uongozi wa taasisi katika masuala ya akili bandia.

KUTOKA KWA KIKUNDI

12 Sep 2026 **Tasnifu ya uzamivu imekamilika; mhitimu atatunukiwa shahada Desemba 2026**
Marekebisho yaliyotakiwa na watahini yamekubaliwa katika utafiti kuhusu wanafunzi wa masafa wanaofanya vizuri sana katika elimu ya juu Afrika Mashariki.

12 Sep 2026 **Ripoti ya utafiti wa uzamili imekamilika kwa daraja la heshima; mhitimu atatunukiwa shahada Desemba 2026**
Mapitio ya kibibliometriki kuhusu uongozi na usanifu wa sera unaotegemea data; hatua inayofuata ni pendekezo la utafiti wa uzamivu.

MAKALA TUNAZOPENDEKEZA KUSOMA

Development as Freedom Amartya Sen, Oxford University Press (1999). Herufi H katika AHEAD. Anzia hapa.

With best wishes for the fortnight ahead,

Director: Wits AHEAD

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